

Chapter 6

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Chapter 6: Action Planning and Decision Making

Hey there, future achievers! To make Chapter 6 even more actionable, we’ve expanded our set of worksheets and tools to include additional resources for decision-making and roadmap creation. These are tailored for Indian students aged 18-24, addressing the unique challenges and cultural context you face. Whether you’re aiming for a tech job in Bengaluru, cracking UPSC, or launching a startup, these worksheets will guide you step-by-step. Let’s dive into the practical side of planning and decision-making with easy-to-use templates and tools. Print them, fill them out, or adapt them digitally—make them your own!

Worksheet 1: Action Plan Templates

Purpose

These templates help you break down your career goals into specific, manageable tasks with deadlines and resources, ensuring you stay on track. They’re perfect for organizing both short-term (6-12 months) and long-term (3-5 years) plans, helping you navigate the competitive Indian career landscape.

Worksheet 1A: Short-Term Action Plan Template (6-12 Months)

Goal: Write your specific, time-bound goal here (e.g., “Secure a marketing internship in Delhi by June 2026”).

Instructions: List tasks needed to achieve this goal, assign deadlines, note resources, and track status. Review weekly and update as needed. Use color-coding for status (Green = Done, Yellow = In Progress, Red = Not Started).

Task No.	Task Description	Deadline	Resources Needed	Status	Notes/Comments
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					

Task No.

Task Description

Deadline

Resources Needed

Status

Notes/Comments

- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5

Reflection Questions:

- Are the deadlines realistic considering my current schedule (e.g., exams, family duties)?
- Do I have access to all listed resources, or do I need alternatives (e.g., free tools instead of paid ones)?
- What small reward can I give myself after completing the first task (e.g., a favorite snack)?

Indian Context Tip: Include buffer days for unexpected delays like university result announcements or festival breaks (e.g., Diwali). If internet access is limited, list offline resources like library books.

Worksheet 1B: Long-Term Action Plan Template (3-5 Years)

Goal: Write your long-term career goal here (e.g., “Become a software engineer at TCS by 2029”). **Instructions:** Map out major milestones over the next 3-5 years, along with key actions for each. Review quarterly or after major events (e.g., exam results) to adjust timelines.

Year	Milestone	Key Actions	Resources Needed	Progress Check (Date & Notes)
Year 1 (e.g., 2025)				
Year 2 (e.g., 2026)				
Year 3 (e.g., 2027)				
Year 4 (e.g., 2028)				
Year 5 (e.g., 2029)				

Year

Milestone

Key Actions

Resources Needed

Progress Check (Date & Notes)

- Year 1 (e.g., 2025)
- Year 2 (e.g., 2026)
- Year 3 (e.g., 2027)
- Year 4 (e.g., 2028)
- Year 5 (e.g., 2029)

Reflection Questions:

- Do these milestones align with my ultimate goal, or do I need to tweak them?
- Have I accounted for Indian-specific delays like entrance exam rescheduling or semester backlogs?
- What's one challenge I foresee in this timeline (e.g., funding for a course), and how can I prepare for it?

Indian Context Tip: Factor in time for family events (e.g., weddings) or regional holidays that might affect your schedule. Explore government schemes or scholarships (like NSP) to support resource needs.

How to Use These Templates

- **Fill Them Out:** Start with one short-term and one long-term goal from Chapter 5. Break them into tasks or milestones as shown.
- **Track Progress:** Use a pen to mark status or progress, or digitize these tables in Google Sheets for easy updates.
- **Personalize:** Add motivational quotes (e.g., "Mehnat ka phal meetha hota hai") or stickers to keep yourself inspired.
- **Fun Challenge:** Share a photo of your filled template with #MyCareerPlanIndia and tag a friend to join the planning vibe!

Worksheet 2: Decision-Making Tools (Including PACED Process Worksheet and Decision-Making Matrix)

Purpose

These tools help you make informed career decisions using structured frameworks like the PACED process. They're designed to reduce confusion and emotional bias, especially for Indian youth facing pressures from family, society, or competitive environments. Use them to weigh options logically for choices like selecting a college, job, or career path.

Worksheet 2A: Decision-Making (PACED Process) Worksheet

Situation/Problem: (Define the decision you need to make. Example: "Choosing between two job offers.")

Step 1: Problem Definition (P) Describe the challenge or decision.

Step 2: List Alternatives (A) Write down all the possible options.

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Step 3: Establish Criteria (C) What factors are most important? (e.g., salary, growth potential, work environment)

Step 4: Evaluate Alternatives (E) Assess each option based on your criteria. **Option 1:** Pros:

_____ Cons: _____

Option 2: Pros: _____ Cons:

Option 3: Pros: _____ Cons:

Step 5: Make the Decision (D) Based on your evaluation, which option is best? Your Decision:

_____ Reasoning:

Reflection Questions:

- Did including family expectations as a criterion affect my decision? How can I discuss this choice with them?
- Are there any risks with my chosen option (e.g., high fees)? How can I plan for them?
- Do I feel confident about this decision, or do I need more information (e.g., talk to a senior)?

Indian Context Tip: In India, decisions often involve societal norms (e.g., "engineering is safe") or family input. Add "family opinion" or "cultural fit" as a criterion if relevant, and discuss your evaluation with loved ones for smoother acceptance.

Worksheet 2B: Decision-Making Matrix for Weighing Options

Purpose: This matrix helps you visually compare alternatives by scoring them against your criteria, making the evaluation step of PACED more structured and data-driven. It's ideal for complex decisions with multiple factors.

Instructions:

- List your alternatives (options) in the left column.
- List your criteria across the top row and assign a weight (1-5) to each based on importance (5 = most important).
- Score each alternative against each criterion (1-5, where 5 = best fit).
- Multiply the score by the weight for each cell, then total the weighted scores for each alternative.
- The highest total score often indicates the best option (though reflect on qualitative factors too).

Decision Topic: Write the decision you're evaluating (e.g., "Choosing between B.Tech and B.Com").

Alternatives	Criterion 1: ____

(Weight: __)	Criterion 2: ____

(Weight: __)	Criterion 3: ____

(Weight: __)	Criterion 4: ____

(Weight: __)	Total Weighted Score
Option A: _____	Score: __ x Weight = —	Score: __ x Weight = —	Score: __ x Weight = —	Score: __ x Weight = —	_____
Option B: _____	Score: __ x Weight = —	Score: __ x Weight = —	Score: __ x Weight = —	Score: __ x Weight = —	_____
Option C: _____	Score: __ x Weight = —	Score: __ x Weight = —	Score: __ x Weight = —	Score: __ x Weight = —	_____

Alternatives

Criterion 1: _____

(Weight: __)

Criterion 2: _____

(Weight: __)

Criterion 3: _____

(Weight: __)

Criterion 4: _____

(Weight: __)

Total Weighted Score

Option A: _____

Score: __ x Weight = __

Score: __ x Weight = __

Score: __ x Weight = __

Score: __ x Weight = __

Option B: _____

Score: __ x Weight = __

Score: __ x Weight = __

Score: __ x Weight = __

Score: __ x Weight = __

Option C: _____

Score: __ x Weight = __

Score: __ x Weight = __

Score: __ x Weight = __

Score: __ x Weight = __

Example Matrix (Filled for Reference): Decision Topic: "Choosing between B.Tech and B.Com"

Alternatives	Interest in Subject (Weight: 5)	Job Prospects (Weight: 4)	Family Expectations (Weight: 3)	Cost of Education (Weight: 2)	Total Weighted Score
Option A: B.Tech	Score: $4 \times 5 = 20$	Score: $5 \times 4 = 20$	Score: $4 \times 3 = 12$	Score: $2 \times 2 = 4$	56
Option B: B.Com	Score: $3 \times 5 = 15$	Score: $3 \times 4 = 12$	Score: $5 \times 3 = 15$	Score: $4 \times 2 = 8$	50
Option C: B.Com + Coding Course	Score: $4 \times 5 = 20$	Score: $4 \times 4 = 16$	Score: $4 \times 3 = 12$	Score: $3 \times 2 = 6$	54

Alternatives

**Interest in Subject
(Weight: 5)**

**Job Prospects
(Weight: 4)**

**Family Expectations
(Weight: 3)**

**Cost of Education
(Weight: 2)**

Total Weighted Score

Option A: B.Tech

Score: $4 \times 5 = 20$

Score: $5 \times 4 = 20$

Score: $4 \times 3 = 12$

Score: $2 \times 2 = 4$

56

Option B: B.Com

Score: $3 \times 5 = 15$

Score: $3 \times 4 = 12$

Score: $5 \times 3 = 15$

Score: $4 \times 2 = 8$

50

Option C: B.Com + Coding Course

Score: $4 \times 5 = 20$

Score: $4 \times 4 = 16$

Score: $4 \times 3 = 12$

Score: $3 \times 2 = 6$

54

Analysis of Scores: In the example, B.Tech scores highest (56), but B.Com + Coding Course (54) is close and balances cost and interest. Reflect on qualitative factors (e.g., personal passion) before deciding.

Your Analysis of Scores: Write your observations based on the matrix totals. Which option scored highest, and do you agree with it? Why or why not?

Final Decision Based on Matrix: _____

Reflection Questions:

- Did weighting the criteria (e.g., giving "Job Prospects" higher importance) change the outcome? Should I adjust weights?
- Are there unlisted factors (e.g., location of college) I should consider beyond the matrix?
- How can I use this matrix to explain my decision to family or mentors for their buy-in?

Indian Context Tip: Add criteria like "distance from home" or "government scheme availability" (e.g., scholarships) if they impact your decision. In India, practical factors often play a big role alongside personal interest.

How to Use These Decision-Making Tools

- **Start with PACED Framework:** Use Worksheet 2A to outline your decision step-by-step. It's great for brainstorming and initial clarity.
- **Deep Dive with Matrix:** Use Worksheet 2B (Matrix) for a detailed, numerical comparison when options are close or complex. Combine both for tough choices.
- **Discuss and Reflect:** Share your filled worksheets with a trusted friend, senior, or family member for feedback, especially in the Indian context where collective input matters.
- **Fun Challenge:** Turn your matrix into a mini-presentation (2 slides) with your decision as the "hero's choice" in a Bollywood plot. Share with #DecisionDramaIndia for laughs and inspiration!

Worksheet 3: Creating Your Roadmap for Success

Purpose

This worksheet helps you design a clear timeline for your career journey by identifying key milestones and setting estimated dates for achieving them. It's a visual guide to connect your current position to your ultimate goal, tailored for Indian students navigating academic and professional challenges.

Part 1: Milestones and Timeline

Career Goal: Write your long-term career goal here (e.g., "Become a Chartered Accountant by 2030").

Milestones: List 3 key milestones that will mark your progress toward your career goal.

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Timeline: Create a brief timeline with estimated dates for each milestone.

- Milestone 1: _____
- Milestone 2: _____
- Milestone 3: _____

Review and Update: Plan how often you will review your action plan and update your progress. Review Frequency (e.g., quarterly): _____ Notes for Next Review: _____

Part 2: Final Reflection

What did you learn from creating this action plan and decision-making worksheet?

Next Steps: What additional actions or adjustments are needed to move forward?

Reflection Questions:

- Are the dates for my milestones realistic, considering potential delays like university exams or family events?
- How will achieving each milestone bring me closer to my ultimate career goal?
- What support (e.g., mentors, online resources) can I seek to stay on track with this roadmap?

Indian Context Tip: Build buffer time into your timeline for Indian-specific challenges like festival seasons (e.g., Diwali breaks) or unexpected academic delays (e.g., result announcements). Also, consider local resources like government portals (NCS) for opportunities.

How to Use This Roadmap Worksheet

- **Define Your Path:** Start by writing a clear long-term goal and break it into 3 achievable milestones.
- **Set Realistic Dates:** Use your academic or personal calendar to estimate timelines, factoring in breaks or delays common in India.
- **Visualize It:** Draw this timeline on a chart paper as a “Career Rail Yatra” (label milestones as stations) for a fun, visual reminder.
- **Fun Challenge:** Share your roadmap sketch or timeline with #CareerYatraIndia and describe which “train” you are —fast like Shatabdi or steady like Passenger!